about this book

The idea behind CORS is simple: allow one site to make a request to another. It's a fairly trivial thing to do from most programming languages. So why does there need to be a book about it?

Hidden behind this simple idea are a lot of complex concepts. While other programming languages have no restrictions on HTTP requests, things are different in a browser, where the browser's same-origin policy prevents requests from different sites. CORS must balance the need to enable cross-origin requests while preserving the same-origin policy for sites that don't use CORS.

Also, CORS has both a client- and a server-side component. For a cross-origin request to succeed, the client and the server must be in agreement. This is different from other web technologies. For example, CSS lives solely in the client-side code; there is no server-side component.

This book serves as an introduction to CORS and attempts to demystify the issues that make CORS complicated.

What this book will give you

Here is an overview of the topics this book will cover:

- *CORS from the client*—This book starts by looking at how to make CORS requests from JavaScript code. It introduces the `XMLHttpRequest` object, which can be used to make CORS requests. While the `XMLHttpRequest` object may be familiar to JavaScript developers, the book focuses on what is unique about CORS. The